

# Connecticut State Department of Education

## DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2021–22



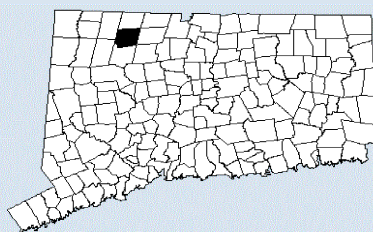
### Explorations District

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#### District Information

|                                     |             |
|-------------------------------------|-------------|
| Grade Range                         | 9-12        |
| Number of Schools/Programs          | 1           |
| Enrollment                          | 89          |
| Per Pupil Expenditures <sup>1</sup> | \$20,001    |
| Total Expenditures <sup>1</sup>     | \$1,720,071 |

<sup>1</sup> Expenditure data reflect the 2020-21 school year.



#### Community Information

AdvanceCT Town Profiles provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities at <https://www.advancect.org/site-selection/town-profiles>

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#### Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2021-22 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

\* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality. Complete data suppression guidelines are available at <https://tinyurl.com/SuppressionPolicy>

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

#### Students

##### October 1, 2021 Enrollment<sup>2</sup>

|                                           | District |                      | State                |
|-------------------------------------------|----------|----------------------|----------------------|
|                                           | Count    | Percent of Total (%) | Percent of Total (%) |
| Female                                    | *        | *                    | 48.5                 |
| Male                                      | 44       | 49.4                 | 51.5                 |
| Non-Binary                                | *        | *                    | 0.1                  |
| American Indian or Alaska Native          | 0        | 0.0                  | 0.3                  |
| Asian                                     | 0        | 0.0                  | 5.1                  |
| Black or African American                 | *        | *                    | 12.6                 |
| Hispanic or Latino of any race            | 12       | 13.5                 | 29.0                 |
| Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander | 0        | 0.0                  | 0.1                  |
| Two or More Races                         | *        | *                    | 4.3                  |
| White                                     | 70       | 78.7                 | 48.6                 |
| English Learners/Multilingual Learners    | 0        | 0.0                  | 8.8                  |
| Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals  | 58       | 65.2                 | 40.6                 |
| Students with Disabilities <sup>3</sup>   | 31       | 34.8                 | 16.7                 |

<sup>2</sup> This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

<sup>3</sup> Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

##### Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

|                                          | Chronic Absenteeism <sup>4</sup> |          | Suspension/Expulsion <sup>5</sup> |          |
|------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|----------|-----------------------------------|----------|
|                                          | Count                            | Rate (%) | Count                             | Rate (%) |
| Female                                   | 16                               | 34.0     | *                                 | *        |
| Male                                     | *                                | *        | *                                 | *        |
| Non-Binary                               | *                                | *        | 0                                 | *        |
| Black or African American                | 0                                | *        | 0                                 | *        |
| Hispanic or Latino of any race           | *                                | *        | *                                 | *        |
| White                                    | 23                               | 31.5     | *                                 | *        |
| English Learners/Multilingual Learners   | N/A                              | N/A      | N/A                               | N/A      |
| Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals | 21                               | 36.8     | *                                 | *        |
| Students with Disabilities               | 10                               | 41.7     | *                                 | *        |
| District                                 | 29                               | 33.3     | *                                 | *        |
| State                                    |                                  | 23.7     |                                   | 6.5      |

**Number of students qualified as truant under state statute: 31**

**Number of school-based arrests: 0**

<sup>4</sup> A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

<sup>5</sup> This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

# District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

## Explorations District

### Educators

#### Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)<sup>1</sup> Staff

|                                                           | FTE |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|-----|
| <b>General Education</b>                                  |     |
| Teachers and Instructors                                  | 9.1 |
| Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants                 | 0.2 |
| <b>Special Education</b>                                  |     |
| Teachers and Instructors                                  | 1.0 |
| Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants                 | 0.8 |
| <b>Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs</b> |     |
| District Central Office                                   | 0.5 |
| School Level                                              | 2.0 |
| <b>Library/Media</b>                                      |     |
| Specialists (Certified)                                   | 0.0 |
| Support Staff                                             | 0.0 |
| Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers            | 0.0 |
| Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists       | 1.0 |
| School Nurses                                             | 0.9 |
| Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support  | 3.6 |

<sup>1</sup> In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

#### Educators by Race/Ethnicity

|                                           | Count | District<br>Percent of Total<br>(%) | State<br>Percent of Total<br>(%) |
|-------------------------------------------|-------|-------------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| American Indian or Alaska Native          | 0     | 0.0                                 | 0.1                              |
| Asian                                     | 0     | 0.0                                 | 1.3                              |
| Black or African American                 | 0     | 0.0                                 | 4.3                              |
| Hispanic or Latino of any race            | 0     | 0.0                                 | 4.6                              |
| Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander | 0     | 0.0                                 | 0.1                              |
| Two or More Races                         | 1     | 6.7                                 | 0.2                              |
| White                                     | 14    | 93.3                                | 89.2                             |

#### Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2020-21

|                                                                   | District | State |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|-------|
| Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time | 5.0      | 10.4  |

### Instruction and Resources

#### 11th and 12th Graders Enrolled in College-and-Career-Readiness Courses during High School<sup>2</sup>

|                                          | 11th  |          | 12th  |          |
|------------------------------------------|-------|----------|-------|----------|
|                                          | Count | Rate (%) | Count | Rate (%) |
| Black or African American                | N/A   | N/A      | N/A   | N/A      |
| Hispanic or Latino of any race           | 0     | *        | 0     | *        |
| White                                    | 0     | 0.0      | *     | *        |
| English Learners/Multilingual Learners   | N/A   | N/A      | N/A   | N/A      |
| Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals | 0     | *        | *     | *        |
| Students with Disabilities               | 0     | *        | 0     | *        |
| District                                 | 0     | 0.0      | *     | *        |
| State                                    |       | 81.7     |       | 87.7     |

<sup>2</sup> College-and-Career-Readiness Courses include Advanced Placement®(AP), International Baccalaureate®(IB), Career and Technical Education(CTE), workplace experience and dual credit courses.

#### Students with Disabilities Who Spend 79.1 to 100 Percent of Time with Nondisabled Peers<sup>3</sup>

|                            | Count | Rate (%) |
|----------------------------|-------|----------|
| Autism                     | N/A   | N/A      |
| Emotional Disturbance      | N/A   | N/A      |
| Intellectual Disability    | N/A   | N/A      |
| Learning Disability        | N/A   | N/A      |
| Other Health Impairment    | N/A   | N/A      |
| Other Disabilities         | N/A   | N/A      |
| Speech/Language Impairment | N/A   | N/A      |
| District                   | N/A   | N/A      |
| State                      |       | 68.4     |

<sup>3</sup> This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

# District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

## Explorations District

### Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability<sup>1</sup>

|                            | District |          | State    |
|----------------------------|----------|----------|----------|
|                            | Count    | Rate (%) | Rate (%) |
| Autism                     | N/A      | N/A      | 2.3      |
| Emotional Disturbance      | N/A      | N/A      | 1.1      |
| Intellectual Disability    | N/A      | N/A      | 0.6      |
| Learning Disability        | N/A      | N/A      | 6.1      |
| Other Health Impairment    | N/A      | N/A      | 3.3      |
| Other Disabilities         | N/A      | N/A      | 1.1      |
| Speech/Language Impairment | N/A      | N/A      | 1.9      |
| All Disabilities           | N/A      | N/A      | 16.3     |

<sup>1</sup> This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

### Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District<sup>2</sup>

|                                   | District |          | State    |
|-----------------------------------|----------|----------|----------|
|                                   | Count    | Rate (%) | Rate (%) |
| Public Schools in Other Districts | N/A      | N/A      | 8.2      |
| Private Schools or Other Settings | N/A      | N/A      | 4.6      |

<sup>2</sup> This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

### Overall Expenditures<sup>3</sup>: 2020-21

|                                                | Total (\$)  | Per Pupil     |            |
|------------------------------------------------|-------------|---------------|------------|
|                                                |             | District (\$) | State (\$) |
| Instruction                                    | \$763,164   | \$8,874       | \$12,000   |
| Support services - students                    | \$133,209   | \$1,549       | \$1,468    |
| Support services - instruction                 | \$55,815    | \$649         | \$780      |
| Support services - general administration      | \$52,429    | \$610         | \$472      |
| Support services - school based administration | \$421,560   | \$4,902       | \$1,103    |
| Central and other support services             | .           | .             | \$703      |
| Operation and maintenance of plant             | \$261,855   | \$3,045       | \$1,910    |
| Student transportation services                | \$32,039    | \$1,001       | \$1,287    |
| Food services                                  | .           | .             | \$28       |
| Enterprise operations                          | .           | .             | \$170      |
| Total                                          | \$1,720,071 | \$20,001      | \$19,134   |

<sup>3</sup> Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

### Special Education Expenditures: 2020-21

|                                                          | District   |                      | State                |
|----------------------------------------------------------|------------|----------------------|----------------------|
|                                                          | Total (\$) | Percent of Total (%) | Percent of Total (%) |
| Teacher Salaries                                         | \$251,531  | 61.5                 | 29.7                 |
| Instructional Aide Salaries                              | .          | .                    | 10.8                 |
| Other Salaries                                           | \$70,452   | 17.2                 | 9.8                  |
| Employee Benefits                                        | \$33,810   | 8.3                  | 13.8                 |
| Purchased Services Other Than Transportation             | \$15,555   | 3.8                  | 5.7                  |
| Special Education Tuition                                | .          | .                    | 22.6                 |
| Supplies                                                 | \$8,962    | 2.2                  | 0.6                  |
| Property Services                                        | \$6,407    | 1.6                  | 0.4                  |
| Purchased Services For Transportation                    | .          | .                    | 6.3                  |
| Equipment                                                | \$22,407   | 5.5                  | 0.2                  |
| All Other Expenditures                                   | .          | .                    | 0.1                  |
| Total                                                    | \$409,124  | 100.0                | 100.0                |
| Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education |            | 23.8                 | 24.5                 |

### Expenditures by Revenue Source<sup>4</sup>: 2020-21

|                 | Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction |
|-----------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| Local           | 23.8                                               |
| State           | 52.6                                               |
| Federal         | 22.7                                               |
| Tuition & Other | 0.9                                                |

<sup>4</sup> Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

# District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

## Explorations District

### Performance and Accountability

#### District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

|                                                | English Language Arts (ELA) |     | Math  |     | Science |     |
|------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|-----|-------|-----|---------|-----|
|                                                | Count                       | DPI | Count | DPI | Count   | DPI |
| American Indian or Alaska Native               | 0                           | N/A | 0     | N/A | 0       | N/A |
| Asian                                          | 0                           | N/A | 0     | N/A | 0       | N/A |
| Black or African American                      | 0                           | N/A | 0     | N/A | 0       | N/A |
| Hispanic or Latino of any race                 | *                           | *   | *     | *   | *       | *   |
| Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander      | 0                           | N/A | 0     | N/A | 0       | N/A |
| Two or More Races                              | 0                           | N/A | 0     | N/A | 0       | N/A |
| White                                          | *                           | *   | *     | *   | *       | *   |
| English Learners/Multilingual Learners         | 0                           | N/A | 0     | N/A | 0       | N/A |
| Non-English Learners/Non-Multilingual Learners | 19                          | *   | 19    | *   | 19      | *   |
| Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals       | *                           | *   | *     | *   | *       | *   |
| Not Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals   | *                           | *   | *     | *   | *       | *   |
| Students with Disabilities                     | 8                           | *   | 8     | *   | 8       | *   |
| Students without Disabilities                  | 11                          | *   | 11    | *   | 11      | *   |
| High Needs                                     | *                           | *   | *     | *   | *       | *   |
| Non-High Needs                                 | *                           | *   | *     | *   | *       | *   |
| District                                       | 19                          | *   | 19    | *   | 19      | *   |

#### National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient<sup>1</sup>

|                 | NAEP 2022 |         | NAEP 2013 |
|-----------------|-----------|---------|-----------|
|                 | Grade 4   | Grade 8 | Grade 12  |
| <b>READING</b>  |           |         |           |
| Connecticut     | 35        | 35      | 50        |
| National Public | 32        | 29      | 36        |
| <b>MATH</b>     |           |         |           |
| Connecticut     | 37        | 30      | 32        |
| National Public | 35        | 26      | 25        |

<sup>1</sup> NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at [https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card\\_NAEP-2022.pdf](https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2022.pdf)

#### Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard<sup>2</sup>

|                      | Percent of Students by Grade <sup>3</sup> (%) |      |      |      | All Tested Grades |          |
|----------------------|-----------------------------------------------|------|------|------|-------------------|----------|
|                      | 4                                             | 6    | 8    | HS   | Count             | Rate (%) |
| Sit & Reach          | N/A                                           | N/A  | N/A  | *    | 13                | *        |
| Curl Up              | N/A                                           | N/A  | N/A  | *    | 13                | *        |
| Push Up              | N/A                                           | N/A  | N/A  | *    | 13                | *        |
| Mile Run/PACER       | N/A                                           | N/A  | N/A  | *    | 13                | *        |
| All Tests - District | N/A                                           | N/A  | N/A  | *    | 13                | *        |
| All Tests - State    | 48.9                                          | 46.7 | 44.3 | 43.3 |                   | 45.8     |

<sup>2</sup>The Connecticut Physical Fitness Assessment (CPFA) is administered to students in Grades 4, 6, 8 and High School (HS). The health-related fitness scores gathered through the CPFA should be used to educate and motivate children and their families to increase physical activity and develop lifetime fitness habits.

<sup>3</sup>Only students assessed in all four areas are included in this calculation.

# District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

## Explorations District

### Cohort Graduation: Four-Year<sup>1</sup>

|                                          | 2020-21                   |          |
|------------------------------------------|---------------------------|----------|
|                                          | Cohort Count <sup>2</sup> | Rate (%) |
| Black or African American                | *                         | *        |
| Hispanic or Latino of any race           | *                         | *        |
| White                                    | 14                        | *        |
| English Learners/Multilingual Learners   | N/A                       | N/A      |
| Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals | 14                        | *        |
| Students with Disabilities               | 8                         | *        |
| District                                 | 18                        | *        |
| State                                    |                           | 89.6     |

<sup>1</sup> The four-year cohort graduation rate represents the percentage of first-time 9th graders who earn a standard high school diploma within four years.

<sup>2</sup> Cohort count includes all students in the cohort as of the end of the 2020-21 school year.

### 11th and 12th Graders Demonstrating Postsecondary Readiness<sup>3</sup>

|                                             | Participation <sup>4</sup> | Meeting Benchmark |          |
|---------------------------------------------|----------------------------|-------------------|----------|
|                                             | Rate (%)                   | Count             | Rate (%) |
| Female                                      | 90.3                       | 6                 | 19.4     |
| Male                                        | *                          | 6                 | 26.1     |
| Non-Binary                                  | *                          | 0                 | *        |
| Black or African American                   | N/A                        | N/A               | N/A      |
| Hispanic or Latino                          | *                          | *                 | *        |
| White                                       | *                          | *                 | *        |
| English Learners/<br>Multilingual Learners  | N/A                        | N/A               | N/A      |
| Eligible for Free or<br>Reduced-Price Meals | 95.0                       | *                 | *        |
| Students with Disabilities                  | *                          | *                 | *        |
| District                                    | 92.7                       | 12                | 21.8     |
| State                                       | 95.0                       |                   | 43.5     |

<sup>3</sup> Students demonstrate postsecondary readiness through at least one of the following:

- SAT® - meets benchmark score on SAT, Revised SAT or Connecticut School Day SAT
- ACT® - meets benchmark score on 3 of 4 exams (benchmark score varies by subject)
- AP® - 3 or higher on any one AP® exam
- IB® - 4 or higher on any one IB® exam
- Earning three or more non-remedial college credits cumulatively during high school.

<sup>4</sup> Participation Rate equals the number of test-takers in 11th and 12th grade divided by the number of students enrolled in those grades, as a percentage.

Sources:

SAT® and AP® statistics derived from data provided by the College Board.

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ACT® statistics derived from data provided by ACT, Inc.

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IB® statistics derived from data provided by the International Baccalaureate Organization.

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### College Entrance and Persistence

|                                             | Class of 2021         | Class of 2020            |
|---------------------------------------------|-----------------------|--------------------------|
|                                             | Entrance <sup>5</sup> | Persistence <sup>6</sup> |
|                                             | Rate (%)              | Rate (%)                 |
| Female                                      | *                     | *                        |
| Male                                        | *                     | *                        |
| Non-Binary                                  | N/A                   | N/A                      |
| Black or African American                   | *                     | *                        |
| Hispanic or Latino of any race              | N/A                   | *                        |
| White                                       | *                     | *                        |
| English Learners/<br>Multilingual Learners  | N/A                   | N/A                      |
| Eligible for Free or<br>Reduced-Price Meals | *                     | *                        |
| Students with Disabilities                  | *                     | *                        |
| District                                    | *                     | *                        |
| State                                       | 66.1                  | 84.9                     |

<sup>5</sup> College entrance refers to the percent of high school graduates from the year who enrolled in college any time during the first year after high school.

<sup>6</sup> College persistence refers to the percent of students who enrolled in college the first year after high school and returned for a second year (Freshman to Sophomore persistence).

Source: National Student Clearinghouse

# District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

## Explorations District

### Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

| Indicator                                                 |                     | Index/Rate | Target | Points Earned | Max Points | % Points Earned | State Average Index/Rate |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|------------|--------|---------------|------------|-----------------|--------------------------|
| ELA Performance Index                                     | All Students        | .          | 75     | .             | .          | .               | 64.2                     |
|                                                           | High Needs Students | .          | 75     | .             | .          | .               | 54.2                     |
| Math Performance Index                                    | All Students        | .          | 75     | .             | .          | .               | 58.6                     |
|                                                           | High Needs Students | .          | 75     | .             | .          | .               | 47.7                     |
| Science Performance Index                                 | All Students        | .          | 75     | .             | .          | .               | 61.4                     |
|                                                           | High Needs Students | .          | 75     | .             | .          | .               | 51.3                     |
| ELA Academic Growth                                       | All Students        | .          | 100%   | .             | .          | .               | 60.4%                    |
|                                                           | High Needs Students | .          | 100%   | .             | .          | .               | 56.2%                    |
| Math Academic Growth                                      | All Students        | .          | 100%   | .             | .          | .               | 65.2%                    |
|                                                           | High Needs Students | .          | 100%   | .             | .          | .               | 59.1%                    |
| Progress Toward English Proficiency                       | Literacy            | .          | 100%   | .             | .          | .               | 64.9%                    |
|                                                           | Oral                | .          | 100%   | .             | .          | .               | 57.4%                    |
| Chronic Absenteeism                                       | All Students        | 33.3%      | <=5%   | 0.0           | 50         | 0.0             | 23.7%                    |
|                                                           | High Needs Students | 37.1%      | <=5%   | 0.0           | 50         | 0.0             | 34.0%                    |
| Preparation for CCR                                       | % Taking Courses    | 3.6%       | 75%    | 2.4           | 50         | 4.8             | 84.8%                    |
|                                                           | % Meeting Benchmark | 21.8%      | 75%    | 14.5          | 50         | 29.1            | 43.5%                    |
| On-track to High School Graduation                        |                     | .          | 94%    | .             | .          | .               | 82.7%                    |
| 4-year Graduation All Students (2021 Cohort)              |                     | .          | 94%    | .             | .          | .               | 89.6%                    |
| 6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2019 Cohort)     |                     | 87.5%      | 94%    | 93.1          | 100        | 93.1            | 85.2%                    |
| Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2021)                    |                     | .          | 75%    | .             | .          | .               | 66.1%                    |
| Physical Fitness (estimated part rate) and (fitness rate) |                     | .   .      | 75%    | .             | .          | .               | 94.0%   45.8%            |
| Arts Access                                               |                     | 55.2%      | 60%    | 46.0          | 50         | 92.0            | 52.4%                    |
| <b>Accountability Index</b>                               |                     |            |        | <b>156.0</b>  | <b>350</b> | <b>44.6</b>     |                          |

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

| Gap Indicators                | Non-High Needs Rate <sup>1</sup> | High Needs Rate | Size of Gap | State Gap Mean +1 Stdev <sup>2</sup> | Is Gap an Outlier? <sup>2</sup> |
|-------------------------------|----------------------------------|-----------------|-------------|--------------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| Achievement Gap Size Outlier? |                                  |                 |             |                                      |                                 |
| ELA Performance Index Gap     | .                                | .               | .           | .                                    |                                 |
| Math Performance Index Gap    | .                                | .               | .           | .                                    |                                 |
| Science Performance Index Gap | .                                | .               | .           | .                                    |                                 |
| Graduation Rate Gap           | .                                | 87.5%           | .           | 10.2%                                | N                               |

<sup>1</sup>If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

<sup>2</sup>If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served. Gap calculations are based on unrounded rates.

| Subject/Student Group |                     | Participation Rate (%) <sup>3</sup> |
|-----------------------|---------------------|-------------------------------------|
| ELA                   | All Students        | 95.5                                |
|                       | High Needs Students | .                                   |
| Math                  | All Students        | 95.5                                |
|                       | High Needs Students | .                                   |
| Science               | All Students        | 100.0                               |
|                       | High Needs Students | .                                   |

<sup>3</sup>Minimum participation standard is 95%.

### Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

Grade 3 ELA Performance Index for Students with Disabilities:

**District: N/A State: 49.7**

# District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

## Explorations District

### Narratives

#### School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

During the 2021-22 school year, students attended Explorations from 19 different towns. School staff found many students had academic deficiencies in basic skills. We used classroom formative tests, STAR 360, and CCSS aligned math assessments to identify students in need of additional support. Teachers have access to data from benchmark testing for both individual and groups of students to use as they planned lessons, created IEP goals, and created Focus Areas. Teachers revised curriculum and planned lessons to better differentiate to meet the needs of all students. Students showing a weakness in Math received increased Math Lab support in addition to their scheduled math class. In staff meetings, staff discussed student specific needs and planned how best to accommodate them in the classroom. We continued an initiative called "The A-Team challenge," designed to improve attendance, academic performance, student behavior, and proficiency on benchmark tests. We had hoped to reinstate the schoolwide attendance challenge, where students with the highest attendance rates would earn a trip at the end of the school year. However, due to uncertainty around Covid-19, we postponed discussion of any trips until summer 2022.

To curb student truancy, we continued a policy where parents were contacted daily by our school nurse or an automated system when students were absent. The contact with parents allowed us to have important conversations around attendance. The school executive director, assistant principal, LMFTA, and nurse worked as members of the school achievement committee. The group revised the process to identify student truancy; these improvements included earlier intervention strategies, revised letters, student conferences, parent meetings, and referrals to outside agencies. The LMFTA made home visits to offer support and solutions to students with poor attendance. The LMFTA addressed a range of social-emotional issues, and worked closely with families, teachers, and administration to implement strategies and work on goals related to student IEPs and other overall social-emotional needs. The school nurse and assistant principal also held weekly meetings to offer support to students and to find ways to improve their grades in the classroom, daily attendance, and to listen to any concerns.

We continued our commitment to supporting the family's role in the education of our students. We continued the use of a "Parent Portal," which allowed parents and students to check grades in all classes in real time, providing transparency and increased communication between parents and staff. We did not hold many of our traditional school activities due to Covid-19, but hopefully we can resume all activities in the upcoming school year. We held a variety of virtual parent meetings and conferences and continued to work with families to ensure that students had access to necessary resources, technology and connectivity. Parents could come to the school building to pick up necessary supplies. When transportation posed a challenge for parents, administrators and staff delivered required items to student homes. Staff regularly communicated with parents to offer support and guidance on helping their students.

#### Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

The school provides opportunities for teachers and students to gain awareness of diversity, differences, and personal experiences. In the classroom, our curriculum encourages discussion of different cultures and backgrounds. This multi-cultural lens exposes students to ideas where they may form personal connections and where they can reflect on acquired knowledge. The school is welcoming of all races, backgrounds, and sexual orientations; students are free to be who they want to be and are accepted by our community.

The location of Explorations in the northwestern corner of the state limits more integrated communities from taking advantage of our school. We place ads on local radio stations, and in local newspapers. We were unable to travel to other schools in 2021-22, as we typically do those visits in the springtime. During the visits, representatives from Explorations make presentations so that we can introduce our program to a wider audience. To help our relative geographic isolation, we provide transportation with three bus stops in Torrington for students at a significant expense to our budget.

Our Friday activities offer unique opportunities for our students. Adventure Education and takes the place of the standard PE classes. Activities include ice skating, biking, kayaking, and hiking. Many students from lower socio-economic backgrounds and who are geographically isolated may have never had the opportunity to participate in these types of activities; for some, these experiences have provided a lifelong interest. Unfortunately, we had to cancel our traditional Unpaid Experiential Learning Program (UELP) for the entire year. This program requires juniors and seniors to participate in an internship designed to give them experience in a future field of employment. This year, juniors and seniors participated in virtual learning, with topics including writing resumes and college entrance essays, work safety training, and job interview skills. When not on Adventure Education, Freshmen and Sophomores experience "Academic Enrichment"; topics include guidance, health, fitness, team building, and remedial and enrichment activities.

Since the 2013-2014 school year our minority population increased from a low of 9.6% in June, 2014 to 21.3% in October, 2021.

# District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

## Explorations District

### **Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools**

As a one building charter school, Explorations allocates all resources in one high school building. The proposed budget of our school is created in late spring by administrators and the board finance committee, voted on by the Governing Board, and is based on full enrollment and funding from the SDE. Adjustments are made after the October 1 count as needed. Grant writing is the greatest supplement to our budget, and we use grants for student and staff need areas. Title I, Title II and Title IV funds are allocated to support programs to support all students. Parents are also essential to aiding our overhead costs. They often provide the school with a variety of products, including paper towels, toilet paper, classroom supplies, and copy paper. Our solar panel project, completed with grant funds in 2019, continues to provide savings on school energy bills as well as enhancing opportunities for integrated units within the Science curriculum.